

CB

Coverboard

Feature Guide

Every feature in the app, where it lives in the code, and the GOV.UK or other reliable source behind it.

48

features

180

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legal & official sources

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diagrams

1. Getting started & people

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6. Pay, payroll & reports

7. Compliance, privacy & security

8. Billing & integrations

9. Website & growth

Generated 08 October 2026 · staging branch

Interactive: click the contents, cross-links, code paths and references.

How to read this guide

Each feature has a card with what it does, how it works, **where it lives in the code** and the **GOV.UK or other reliable source** behind it. Everything blue is clickable: code paths open the file on GitHub (staging branch), references open the source, and feature names jump to that card. Use the bookmarks panel or the [↑ Contents](#) link at the top of every page to move around.

Colour key

Getting started & people	How a team arrives in Coverboard: signing up, choosing a plan, onboarding, inviting people and managing who they are and what they can do.
Leave & holiday	Booking time off, how entitlement is worked out under UK law, and the rules that turn a date range into days, weeks or hours off.
Family & statutory leave	Maternity, paternity, adoption, shared parental, neonatal, bereavement, unpaid parental and carer's leave — and the pay that goes with them.
Sickness, SSP & fit notes	Reporting and logging sickness, Statutory Sick Pay, fit notes and absence monitoring.
Cover & shifts	The heart of the product: minimum staffing per location and shift, who could cover a gap, and asking staff to cover.
Pay, payroll & reports	Earnings history, holiday pay, the payroll export and the reports managers use to stay compliant.
Compliance, privacy & security	Right to work, audit logs, data protection (UK GDPR) and the security controls protecting the app.
Billing & integrations	Plans and payments with Stripe, plus Slack, Jira, email and analytics.
Website & growth	The public website, SEO guides and free tools, and the alerts that tell you when someone signs up.

Symbols

Plan badge	Top-right of each card: which plan the feature needs (e.g. "Growth+" = Growth, Scale and Pro).
Watch out	Amber boxes flag caveats you should know about, including calculations fixed recently.
Developer docs	Links marked this way are technical documentation (Stripe, Vercel...), not legal sources.
Not legal advice	The app implements published rules; check figures with your payroll provider before paying.

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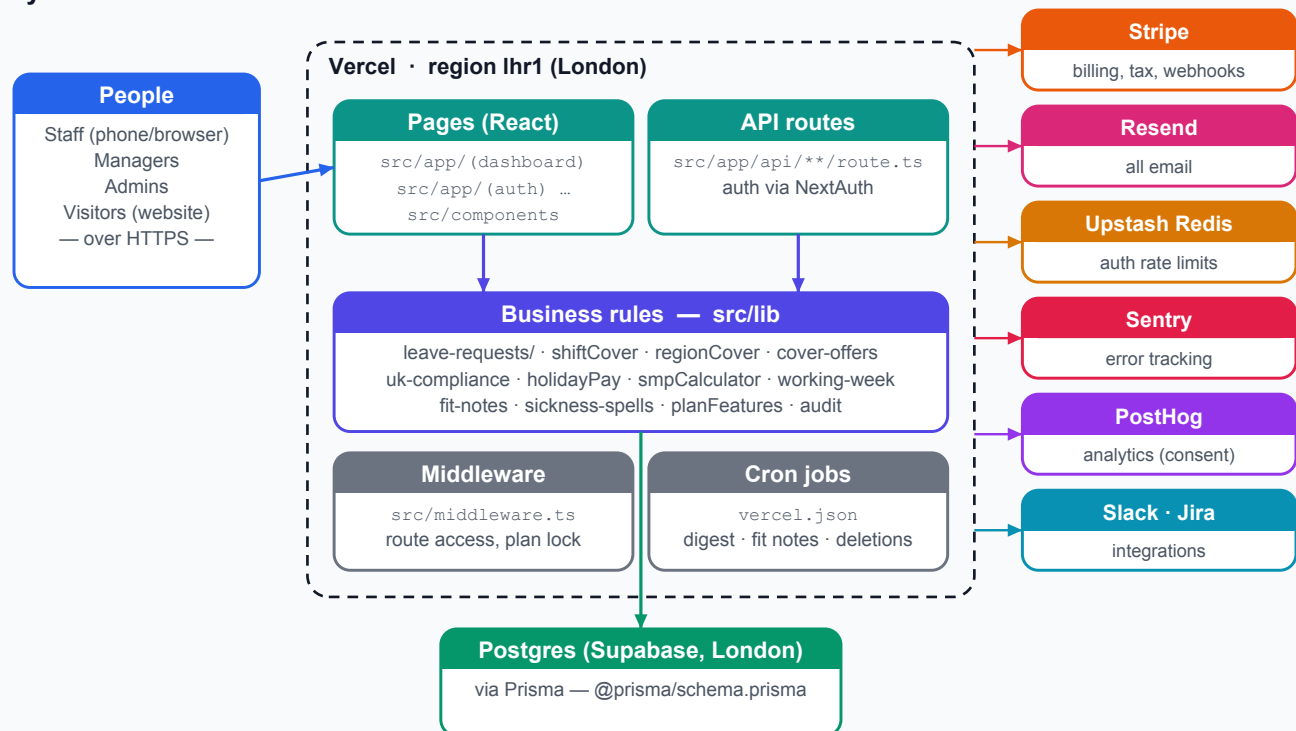
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CHAPTER 0

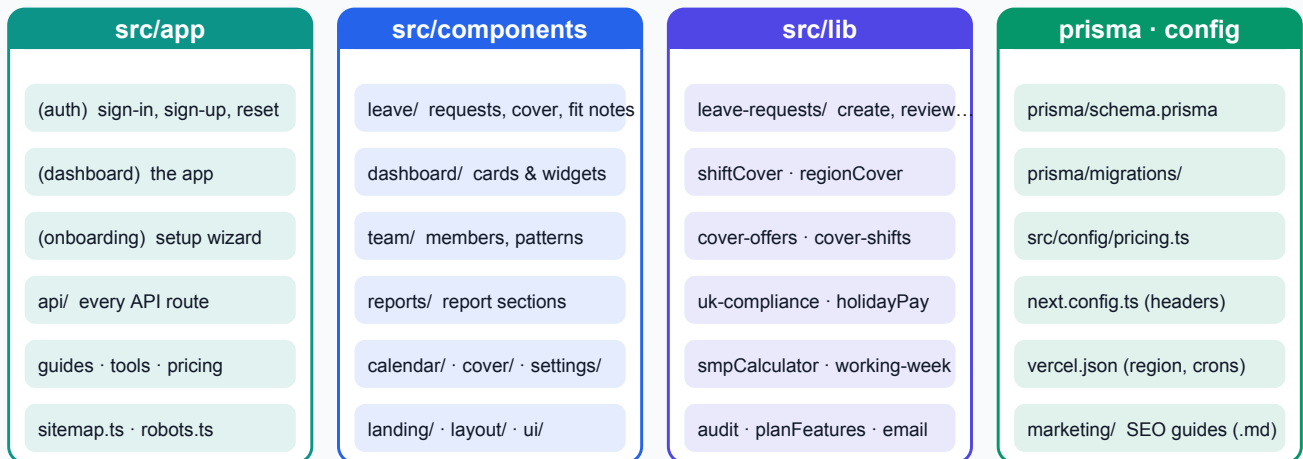
Architecture & diagrams

How Coverboard fits together: the system, the code layout, the data model and the main flows. Read these first to get your bearings.

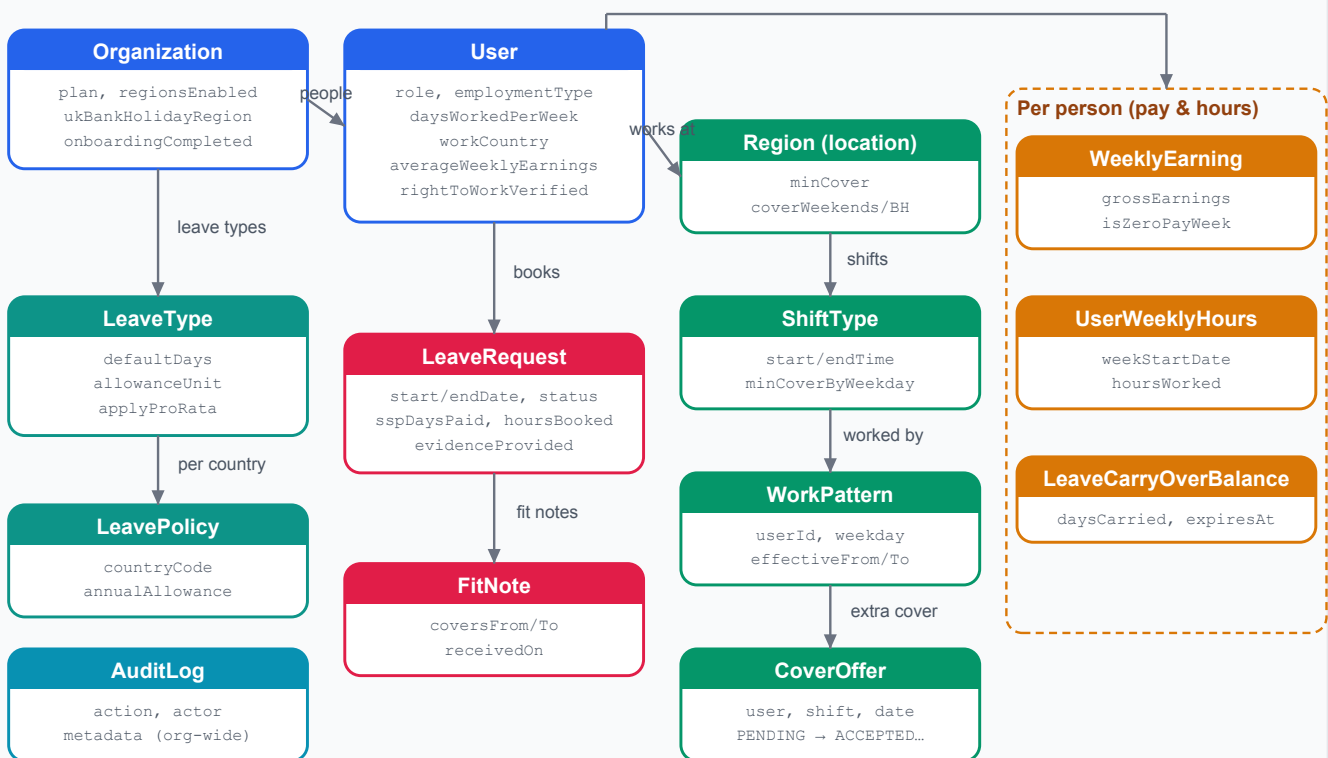
System architecture



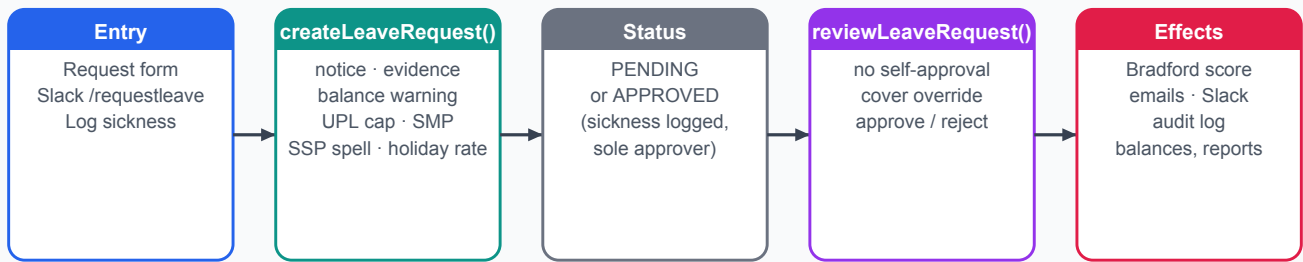
Everything a request touches: the browser talks to the Next.js app on Vercel (London), which reads and writes Postgres through Prisma and calls out to third-party services. Scheduled jobs run on Vercel Cron.

Code map — where things live

Where things live. Pages and API routes are under `src/app`; reusable UI under `src/components`; business rules (the important part) under `src/lib`.

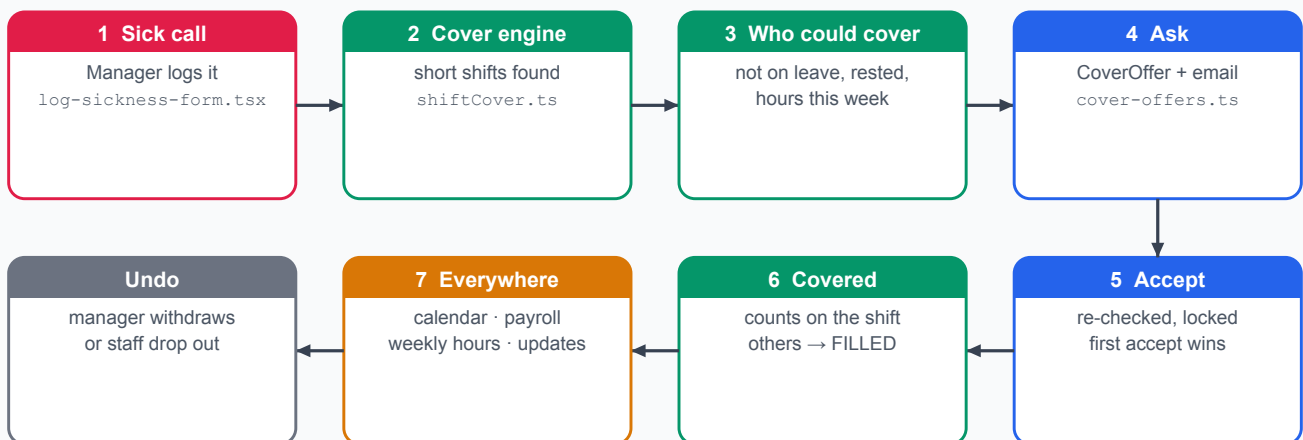
Data model (main tables)

The main tables and how they relate. An Organization has users, leave types, locations and cover offers; a user has leave requests, earnings, weekly hours and a working pattern.

Leave request lifecycle

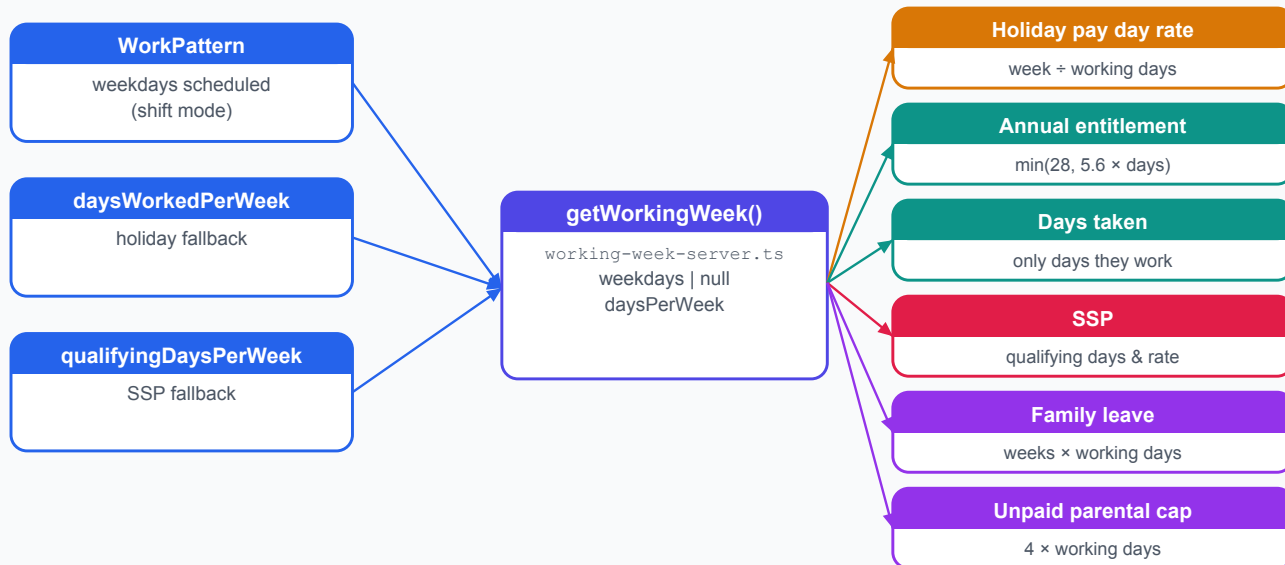
Files: `src/lib/leave-requests/create.ts` · `review.ts` · `rules.ts` · `ssp-spell.ts` · `bradford.ts`

What happens when leave is booked: validation and statutory checks in `createLeaveRequest()`, then approval in `reviewLeaveRequest()`, each step recalculating derived numbers and recording an audit entry.

From a 7:10am sick call to a covered shift

The core story: a sick call becomes a recorded absence, the cover engine finds the gap and candidates, the manager asks, staff accept, and the shift is covered everywhere it matters.

The working week feeds every pay & entitlement calculation



The single source of truth added on 4 Oct 2026: one answer to “which days does this person work?” feeds every pay and entitlement calculation.

Scheduled jobs (vercel.json, times in UTC)

Weekly digest**Mondays 08:00**

Who's off this week, to everyone opted in

`/api/cron/weekly-digest`**Fit-note alerts****Mondays 09:00**

Overdue fit notes to admins/managers (Growth+)

`/api/cron/fit-note-alerts`**Process deletions****Daily 02:00**

Deletes accounts past their 30-day grace

`/api/cron/process-deletions`**Monthly compliance****1st of month 09:00**

Compliance snapshot email (Scale+)

`/api/cron/monthly-compliance-report`

Background jobs scheduled in vercel.json.

Plans & features

Feature flags from `src/lib/planFeatures.ts`. Trials get everything; a locked account gets nothing. Cover (locations, shifts, suggestions and cover requests) is on every plan.

Feature	Free	Starter	Growth	Scale	Pro
Annual leave, requests, calendar, emails	Included	Included	Included	Included	Included
Pro-rata, carry-over rules, bank holiday config	—	Included	Included	Included	Included
SSP, parental tracker, KIT/SPLIT, right to work	—	—	Included	Included	Included
Bradford, holiday pay, earnings history	—	—	Included	Included	Included
Absence analytics, compliance reports, custom types	—	—	—	Included	Included
Priority support	—	—	—	Included	Included
Audit log viewer & exports	—	—	—	—	Included

Prices: Free £0 (up to 5 employees), Starter £19/mo (up to 15), Growth £49/mo, Scale £99/mo, Pro £179/mo — see `src/config/pricing.ts`.

CHAPTER 1

Getting started & people

How a team arrives in Coverboard: signing up, choosing a plan, onboarding, inviting people and managing who they are and what they can do.

In this chapter: [Sign-up, plans & trials](#) · [Onboarding](#) · [Inviting people \(set-password links\)](#) · [Team members & profiles](#) · [Leavers & holiday owed](#) · [Roles & permissions](#)

Sign-up, plans & trials

All plans

A new team signs up with email and password or Google, picks a plan, and gets an organisation with themselves as admin. Paid plans start a 14-day trial; Free has no trial.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Plain /signup and every “Start free” button default to the Free plan; pricing cards pass ?plan= for paid tiers.
- Google sign-up carries the chosen plan through to /welcome, where the team is created.
- provisionTeam() creates the organisation, the admin user and (for paid plans) the Stripe customer and trialing subscription. Stripe failures never block sign-up.
- Every sign-up path runs through provisionTeam(), which also emails you a signup alert.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/app/(auth)/signup/page.tsx</code>	Sign-up form and plan picker
<code>src/app/welcome/page.tsx</code>	Google sign-up completion
<code>src/app/api/auth/signup/route.ts</code>	Email/password sign-up API
<code>src/app/api/auth/complete-signup/route.ts</code>	Google sign-up API
<code>src/lib/provision-team.ts</code>	provisionTeam(): org, admin, Stripe
<code>src/lib/trial.ts</code>	Trial countdown

■ REFERENCES

- › [Stripe – Billing and subscriptions](#) (developer docs)

RELATED: [Plans, billing & VAT](#) · [Signup alerts & founder outreach](#) · [Onboarding](#)

Onboarding

All plans

A three-step setup: which countries the team works in, the industry, and inviting the first people. Choosing the UK switches on UK statutory leave types and bank holidays.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Runs once per team — the API refuses a second run so an old tab can't reset settings.
- Selecting GB calls enableUKStatutoryLeaveTypes() (statutory leave types + policies + bank holidays).
- Invite rows default to the first chosen country; invites without one used to be silently dropped (fixed).
- Healthcare teams are offered “cover by location” straight away.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/app/ (onboarding) /onboarding/page.tsx</code>	Onboarding wizard
<code>src/app/api/onboarding/complete/route.ts</code>	Saves the setup, creates invites
<code>src/lib/uk-statutory.ts</code>	<code>enableUkStatutoryLeaveTypes()</code>
<code>src/lib/country-policies.ts</code>	Leave rules per country

■ REFERENCES

- › [GOV.UK – Holiday entitlement](#)
- › [GOV.UK – UK bank holidays](#)

RELATED: [Inviting people \(set-password links\)](#) · [Statutory leave types \(in weeks\)](#)

Inviting people (set-password links)

All plans

People are added from onboarding, the Team page, or a CSV bulk import. They receive an email with a one-time “Set your password” link — never a password.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Accounts start with a random password nobody knows (`unusablePasswordHash()`).
- The link reuses password-reset tokens: single use, valid 7 days, replaced by any newer link.
- Using the link also verifies their email address.
- Resend invite only sends a fresh link; it never touches an existing password.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/invite-links.ts</code>	<code>createSetPasswordLink()</code> , <code>unusablePasswordHash()</code>
<code>src/lib/email-notifications.ts</code>	<code>sendTeamInviteEmail()</code>
<code>src/app/api/team-members/route.ts</code>	Add a member
<code>src/app/api/team-members/bulk-import/route.ts</code>	CSV bulk import
<code>src/app/api/team-members/[id]/resend-invite/route.ts</code>	Resend invite
<code>src/app/ (auth) /reset-password/page.tsx</code>	“Welcome to Coverboard / Choose your password” page

■ REFERENCES

- › [ICO – Employment practices and data protection](#)

RELATED: [Team members & profiles](#)

Team members & profiles

All plans

The Team page lists everyone with their location, contract and work country. Each profile holds contract details, start date, right-to-work checks, earnings history, working pattern, 48-hour opt-out and children (for unpaid parental leave).

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Work country (not “location”) decides which statutory rules apply.
- Days per week on the profile come from their working pattern, and the stored figure is corrected if it drifts.
- The start date drives starter proration and the 26-week service tests for family pay.
- People who leave are marked as left, not deleted (see Leavers): holiday records must be kept for 6 years.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/app/(dashboard)/team/page.tsx</code>	Team list
<code>src/app/(dashboard)/team/[id]/page.tsx</code>	Profile, leaving dialog
<code>src/components/team/member-card.tsx</code>	Team card (Left / Leaving badges)
<code>src/app/api/team-members/[id]/route.ts</code>	Profile API; marking as left
<code>src/components/team/children.tsx</code>	Children for unpaid parental leave

■ REFERENCES

- › [GOV.UK – Calculate leave entitlement \(part-time, part-year\)](#)

RELATED: [Leavers & holiday owed](#) · [The working week \(one source of truth\)](#) · [Right to work](#) · [Earnings history & average weekly earnings](#)

Leavers & holiday owed

All plans

Admins set someone's last day: in the past if recorded late, or ahead while they work their notice. Their profile shows the holiday they're owed in their final pay.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- The dialog previews what the date cancels or cuts short, and warns when a past date makes them former staff straight away.
- A future date keeps them on the team until then; the nightly job marks them as left the day after.
- Leave after the last day is cancelled, leave running past it is cut short (SSP recalculated), and cover is withdrawn.
- Holiday owed: (entitlement × share of the year worked) – taken, plus carry-over still owed, valued at the 52-week average (reg. 14). Over-taken leave can only be recovered if agreed in writing.
- Leavers appear in the payroll export for the period of their last day.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/leavers.ts</code>	<code>recordLeaving()</code> , <code>previewLeaving()</code> , nightly step
<code>src/lib/holiday-on-leaving.ts</code>	$(A \times B) - C$
<code>src/lib/holiday-on-leaving-server.ts</code>	Holiday owed for a leaver
<code>src/components/team/holiday-on-leaving-card.tsx</code>	Profile card

■ REFERENCES

- › [legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 14 \(pay in lieu on leaving\)](#)
- › [GOV.UK – Taking holiday before leaving a job](#)

RELATED: [Team members & profiles](#) · [Payroll export](#) · [Subject access, retention & deletion](#)

Roles & permissions

Admin limits vary by plan

Three roles: Admin (everything, including billing and settings), Manager (approve leave, log sickness, manage cover) and Member (their own time off, cover requests).

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Members can't open Reports or Audit (middleware redirects them).
- You can't approve your own leave when another approver exists; a sole approver's request auto-approves and is labelled so.
- Cover suggestions and who-was-asked lists are only shown to managers and admins.
- Sickness notes are only visible to the person and admins.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/middleware.ts</code>	Route protection
<code>src/lib/member-route-access.ts</code>	Pages members can't open
<code>src/lib/leave-requests/review.ts</code>	Segregation of duties on approval
<code>src/lib/plans.ts</code>	Admin seats per plan

■ REFERENCES

- > [ICO – Employment practices and data protection](#)
- > [NextAuth.js documentation](#) (developer docs)

RELATED: [Audit log & activity](#)

CHAPTER 2

Leave & holiday

Booking time off, how entitlement is worked out under UK law, and the rules that turn a date range into days, weeks or hours off.

In this chapter: [Leave requests & approvals](#) · [Leave balances & entitlement](#) · [Leave year](#) · [The working week \(one source of truth\)](#) · [Irregular-hours & zero-hours holiday](#) · [Bank holidays](#) · [Carry-over & year-end rollover](#) · [Team calendar](#)

Leave requests & approvals

All plans

Staff request time off; managers approve or reject, or record leave for someone (approved straight away, and they're emailed). Requests check notice, balances, overlap and minimum cover.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Notice is counted in whole calendar days; sickness and manager-recorded leave need none.
- Pending requests can be withdrawn; approved leave only before it starts.
- Admins and managers can cancel someone's approved upcoming leave, after an "Are you sure?" that says the person will be emailed.
- Approving below minimum cover asks for an explicit override, recorded in the audit log.
- Family leave asks for the dates its pay depends on: due date, matching date, days in neonatal care, and whether shared parental pay is claimed.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

src/lib/leave-requests/create.ts	<code>createLeaveRequest()</code> : every check and pay calculation at booking
src/lib/leave-requests/review.ts	Approve/reject
src/app/api/leave-requests/[id]/route.ts	Cancel, and dates added after booking
src/components/leave/request-form.tsx	Booking form
src/components/leave/request-card.tsx	Request cards with pay panels
src/app/(dashboard)/requests/page.tsx	Requests page, cancel confirmation

■ REFERENCES

- > [GOV.UK – Holiday entitlement](#)
- > [Acas – Checking holiday entitlement](#)
- > [Acas – Holiday and sickness](#)

RELATED: [Leave balances & entitlement](#) · [Cover warnings & suggestions](#) · [Audit log & activity](#) · [Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP](#)

Leave balances & entitlement

Pro-rata: Starter+

Each person's allowance, days used, pending and remaining, per leave type and leave year. UK entitlement is 5.6 weeks of their working week, capped at 28 days.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Entitlement = $5.6 \times$ working days per week, rounded up, capped at 28: 28 for a 5-day week, 17 for 3 days.
- Mid-year starters get their share of the leave year from their start date, rounded up (never down).
- Days taken only count days they'd actually have worked.
- Carry-over is used first, soonest-expiring first; when it expires only the unused part lapses.
- Everything counts within the team's leave year (see Leave year).

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/leave-balances.ts</code>	<code>getUserLeaveBalances()</code>
<code>src/lib/uk-compliance.ts</code>	UK entitlement rules
<code>src/lib/working-week.ts</code>	Working week, starter proration
<code>src/lib/carry-over.ts</code>	<code>carryOverInEffect()</code>

■ REFERENCES

- › [GOV.UK – Holiday entitlement: entitlement \(5.6 weeks\)](#)
- › [GOV.UK – Calculate leave entitlement \(part-time, part-year\)](#)
- › [legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 13 \(annual leave\)](#)
- › [GOV.UK – Calculate your holiday entitlement \(calculator\)](#)
- › [legislation.gov.uk – Working Time Regulations 1998](#)

Watch out: Proration and part-time maths were fixed on 4 Oct 2026 after tester feedback — see Known limitations.

RELATED: [Leave year](#) · [The working week \(one source of truth\)](#) · [Irregular-hours & zero-hours holiday](#) · [Carry-over & year-end rollover](#)

Leave year

All plans

Each team sets when its holiday year starts (1 January by default; 1 April is common). Allowances, starters, bank holidays, carry-over, holiday usage and the rollover all count from it.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- A leave year is named by the year it starts in: an April year shows as 2026/27.
- Changing it asks for confirmation, shows the old and new years and what moves, and saves month and day together.
- Carry-over expiry shows the real date, with warnings when carried days would last the whole next year or less than a month.
- Unpaid parental leave has its own per-child year, not this one.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/leave-year.ts</code>	Leave year rules
<code>src/lib/leave-year-server.ts</code>	The team's setting
<code>src/app/(dashboard)/settings/page.tsx</code>	Leave year card

■ REFERENCES

- › [GOV.UK – Holiday entitlement: entitlement \(5.6 weeks\)](#)
- › [legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 13 \(annual leave\)](#)

RELATED: [Leave balances & entitlement](#) · [Carry-over & year-end rollover](#)

The working week (one source of truth)All plans

Which days each person works. Holiday pay, entitlement, days taken, SSP and week-based family leave all depend on it.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- If they have a working pattern, their working days are the weekdays it schedules.
- Otherwise the stored days-per-week is used, with Monday–Friday assumed for counting.
- Saving a pattern updates daysWorkedPerWeek and qualifyingDaysPerWeek to match.
- Added 4 Oct 2026 — before this, many calculations assumed 5 days.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

src/lib/working-week.ts	Pure helpers (+ tests)
src/lib/working-week-server.ts	getWorkingWeek(), syncDaysFromPattern()
src/app/api/team-members/[id]/work-pattern/route.ts	Pattern save syncs day counts

■ REFERENCES

- › [GOV.UK – Calculate leave entitlement \(part-time, part-year\)](#)
- › [GOV.UK – SSP: what you'll get \(£123.25 or 80%, days normally worked\)](#)

RELATED: [Leave balances & entitlement](#) · [Holiday pay \(52-week average\)](#) · [Statutory Sick Pay \(SSP\)](#) · [Shift types & working patterns](#)

Irregular-hours & zero-hours holidayPro-rata: Starter+

Workers without fixed hours accrue holiday at 12.07% of the hours they work, measured in hours (the post-April 2024 method).

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Admins log weekly hours in Reports → Weekly hours; accrual = 12.07% of hours logged this year.
- Bookings deduct hours (default: days × their average day, editable).
- Accepted cover hours are shown beside each week — not added automatically, to avoid double counting.
- Carry-over for these staff is in hours.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

src/lib/uk-compliance.ts	calculateIrregularHoursAccrual()
src/lib/leave-balances.ts	Hours-unit balances
src/app/api/weekly-hours/route.ts	Weekly hours API
src/app/tools/irregular-hours-holiday-calculator/calculator.tsx	Public calculator

■ REFERENCES

- › [GOV.UK – Calculating holiday pay for workers without fixed hours or pay](#)
- › [GOV.UK – Calculate leave entitlement \(part-time, part-year\)](#)

RELATED: [Carry-over & year-end rollover](#) · [Cover in payroll, calendar & hours](#)

Bank holidays

Region config: Starter+

Bank holidays for England & Wales, Scotland and Northern Ireland are seeded and shown on the calendar; teams choose whether they count within the 28 days.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- The team picks its bank-holiday region in Settings.
- Starters only lose the bank holidays after they join.
- Each cover location decides whether minimum cover applies on bank holidays.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/uk-compliance.ts</code>	Easter & bank holiday calculation
<code>src/app/api/holidays/route.ts</code>	Holidays API
<code>src/lib/coverDays.ts</code>	Whether cover applies on a day

■ REFERENCES

- > [GOV.UK – UK bank holidays](#)
- > [GOV.UK – Holiday entitlement: entitlement \(5.6 weeks\)](#)

RELATED: [Leave balances & entitlement](#)

Carry-over & year-end rollover

Carry-over rules: Starter+

At the leave year end, the rollover carries leave forward for four reasons, each with its own expiry, and shows a per-person preview before it runs.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- After sickness: the untaken part of the 4 weeks (all untaken hours for irregular-hours staff), no more than the days off, for 18 months (reg. 13(15)).
- After family leave: all statutory leave they couldn't take, including the extra 1.6 weeks (up to 28 days), to the end of next year (reg. 13(14), 13A(7A)).
- When the employer didn't give the chance to take it, or warn it would be lost: the untaken 4 weeks, to the end of next year (reg. 13(16)–(18)). A per-person tick.
- Company carry-over: from what's left, up to the team's cap, expiring on the date set in Settings (with the actual date and warnings shown).
- Longer-lasting reasons are applied first, so nothing counts twice; re-running replaces that person's carry-over.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/carry-over.ts</code>	<code>planYearEndCarryOver()</code> : the four reasons
<code>src/app/api/carry-over/process/route.ts</code>	Preview and run
<code>src/app/(dashboard)/reports/page.tsx</code>	Year-end rollover screen

■ REFERENCES

- > [legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 13 \(annual leave\)](#)
- > [Acas – Holiday and sickness](#)
- > [GOV.UK – Holiday entitlement](#)

RELATED: [Leave balances & entitlement](#) · [Leave year](#)

Team calendar

All plans

A month view of approved absences, bank holidays, accepted cover shifts and (per location) whether minimum cover is met each day.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Managers see everyone; members see their own leave and cover.
- Filter by location; green outlined chips are cover shifts.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

src/app/ (dashboard) /calendar/page.tsx	Calendar page
src/components/calendar/month-view.tsx	Month grid
src/components/calendar/day-cell.tsx	Day cell
src/app/api/cover-shifts/route.ts	Cover shifts for the calendar

■ REFERENCES

- > [GOV.UK – UK bank holidays](#)

RELATED: [Cover in payroll, calendar & hours](#)

CHAPTER 3

Family & statutory leave

Maternity, paternity, adoption, shared parental, neonatal, bereavement, unpaid parental and carer's leave — and the pay that goes with them.

In this chapter: [Statutory leave types \(in weeks\)](#) · [Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP](#) · [Paternity leave & SPP](#) · [Shared parental leave & ShPP](#) · [Neonatal care leave & pay](#) · [KIT & SPLIT days](#) · [Bereavement, unpaid parental & carer's leave](#)

Statutory leave types (in weeks)

Parental tracker: Growth+

UK statutory family leave is set in weeks of the person's normal working week, then converted to days for them.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Paternity 2 weeks · Bereavement 2 · Unpaid parental 4 a year per child (18 per child) · Carer's 1 · Maternity 52 · Adoption 52 · Shared parental 50 · Neonatal 12.
- LeaveType.allowanceUnit = WEEKS; balances multiply by their working days (2 weeks = 10 days on 5 days, 6 on 3).
- The parental tracker, compliance pack and return alerts read one shared list of these types, so none is missed.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

src/lib/country-policies.ts	UK rules (allowanceUnit: WEEKS)
src/lib/uk-statutory.ts	Creates the types per team
prisma/schema.prisma	LeaveType.allowanceUnit
src/lib/leave-balances.ts	Weeks → days per person

■ REFERENCES

- > [GOV.UK – Paternity pay and leave](#)
- > [GOV.UK – Parental Bereavement Pay and Leave](#)
- > [GOV.UK – Unpaid parental leave](#)
- > [GOV.UK – Carer's leave](#)
- > [GOV.UK – Maternity leave \(52 weeks\)](#)

RELATED: [Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP](#) · [The working week \(one source of truth\)](#)

Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP

Growth+

52 weeks' leave (a day-one right). Statutory Maternity or Adoption Pay: 6 weeks at 90% of average weekly earnings, then 33 weeks at the lower of the flat rate or 90%.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Maternity: earnings from the 8 weeks up to the qualifying week (15 weeks before the due week); 26 weeks' service by then.
- Adoption: the same, from the matching week (the week they were told of the match).
- 26 weeks counts Sunday–Saturday weeks and any part of a week, so the latest start is the Saturday 25 weeks before (corrected 7 Oct; it was a week too strict).
- Recalculated whenever earnings change and when the request is viewed; the card shows the week, the rates, the last day of each phase and how many of the 8 weeks had pay.
- The due or matching date can be added on the card after booking.
- Payroll pays the days of each pay period at the weekly rate ÷ 7, split across the 90% and flat-rate weeks.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/smp-dates.ts</code>	Qualifying/matching week, service test, pay per period
<code>src/lib/smp-request.ts</code>	computeSmpFields(), recalculation
<code>src/lib/smpCalculator.ts</code>	Rates and average earnings
<code>src/components/leave/smp-summary.tsx</code>	Pay panels on request cards

■ REFERENCES

- › [GOV.UK – Employers: maternity pay and leave](#)
- › [GOV.UK – Employers: adoption pay and leave](#)
- › [GOV.UK – Employers: adoption pay eligibility \(matching week\)](#)
- › [legislation.gov.uk – SPP and SAP \(General\) Regs 2002, reg. 40 \(adoption earnings period\)](#)
- › [GOV.UK – Maternity benefits: technical guidance \(26 weeks into the qualifying week\)](#)
- › [HMRC manual – Continuous employment \(statutory payments\)](#)
- › [GOV.UK – Rates and thresholds for employers 2026 to 2027](#)

RELATED: [KIT & SPLIT days](#) · [Earnings history & average weekly earnings](#) · [Payroll export](#)

Paternity leave & SPP

Growth+

1 or 2 weeks (may be split), within 52 weeks of the birth or placement. Statutory Paternity Pay: the lower of the flat rate or 90% of average weekly earnings.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Booking asks whether it's for a birth or an adoption, then the due date or matching date.
- Earnings from the 8 weeks up to the qualifying week (or matching week), with 26 weeks' service by then; the card names the week.
- Without a date, it uses the leave start and says so; the date can be added on the card.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/smp-request.ts</code>	computeSpp() (shared with ShPP and neonatal pay)
<code>src/lib/smp-dates.ts</code>	parentPayDates(): which date counts
<code>src/lib/leave-requests/create.ts</code>	52-week window

■ REFERENCES

- › [GOV.UK – Employers: paternity pay and leave](#)
- › [GOV.UK – Paternity pay and leave](#)

RELATED: [Shared parental leave & ShPP](#) · [Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP](#)

Shared parental leave & ShPP

Growth+

Up to 50 weeks shared, with Shared Parental Pay for up to 37: the lower of the flat rate or 90% of earnings, every week.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Each booking says whether their notice claims pay for those weeks; unpaid blocks show as £0 in payroll.
- The pool is 39 weeks less the mother's or adopter's own SMP/SAP weeks (at least 2) when the app holds them, otherwise 37.
- Claims over the pool are refused; the card shows the weeks left and the week the pay comes from.
- The partner's eligibility is their declaration; employers don't have to check it.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/smp-dates.ts</code>	shppPoolWeeks(), shppClaimError()
<code>src/lib/smp-request.ts</code>	computeShpp(), shppPoolForChild()

■ REFERENCES

- › [GOV.UK – Shared Parental Leave and Pay: employer guide](#)
- › [GOV.UK – Shared parental leave and pay: employers' technical guide](#)
- › [GOV.UK – Shared Parental Leave and Pay](#)

RELATED: [Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP](#) · [Paternity leave & SPP](#) · [KIT & SPLIT days](#)

Neonatal care leave & pay

Growth+

One week of leave and pay for every 7 full days in neonatal care, up to 12, taken within 68 weeks of the birth. Pay: the lower of the flat rate or 90% of earnings.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Booking records the first and last full days in care (employers must keep them); older bookings can add them on the card.
- Pay week: the qualifying or matching week if they'd get SMP, SPP or SAP, otherwise the week before the baby went into care. The card names it.
- Bookings beyond the weeks the time in care gives, or past 68 weeks, are refused (or flagged on older bookings).
- Shown on the parental tracker and compliance pack; payroll pays calendar days at the weekly rate ÷ 7.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

```
src/lib/neonatalPay.ts
```

Weeks from time in care, booking checks

```
src/lib/smp-request.ts
```

computeSncp()

■ REFERENCES

- › [GOV.UK – Employers: neonatal care pay and leave](#)
- › [GOV.UK – Employers: neonatal care pay eligibility \(relevant week\)](#)
- › [GOV.UK – Neonatal care pay and leave](#)

RELATED: [Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP](#) · [Payroll export](#)

KIT & SPLIT days

Growth+

“Keeping in touch” days during maternity/adoption leave and SPLIT days during shared parental leave can be recorded on the request.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Managers record days used on the request (validated 0–20).

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

```
src/app/api/leave-requests/[id]/route.ts
```

kitDaysUsed / splitDaysUsed

■ REFERENCES

- › [GOV.UK – Employers: maternity leave \(incl. KIT days\)](#)
- › [GOV.UK – Shared Parental Leave: employer guidance \(SPLIT days\)](#)

RELATED: [Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP](#)

Bereavement, unpaid parental & carer's leave

All plans

Parental bereavement leave (2 weeks), unpaid parental leave (18 weeks per child, at most 4 a year per child) and carer's leave (1 week a year).

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Children are recorded on the profile, with weeks taken with previous employers, a placement date if adopted, and whether they get a disability benefit.
- The 4-week limit runs in each child's own year: 12 months from when the employee became entitled, renewing each anniversary. That's the birth or placement, or their start date if later (a day-one right since 6 April 2026; before then, a year's service).
- Weeks are their working week (4 weeks = 12 days for a 3-day worker); leave must end before the child's 18th birthday.
- Leave is booked in whole weeks unless the child gets Disability Living Allowance, Personal Independence Payment or Armed Forces Independence Payment, when single days are allowed.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

src/lib/unpaid-parental.ts	Per-child limits and the child's year
src/lib/children-server.ts	Children and usage
src/lib/leave-requests/create.ts	Booking checks

■ REFERENCES

- > [GOV.UK – Unpaid parental leave](#)
- > [legislation.gov.uk – Maternity and Parental Leave etc. Regs 1999, Sch. 2 \(the 4-week year per child\)](#)
- > [GOV.UK – Parental Bereavement Pay and Leave](#)
- > [GOV.UK – Carer's leave](#)

RELATED: [Statutory leave types \(in weeks\)](#) · [Team members & profiles](#)

CHAPTER 4

Sickness, SSP & fit notes

Reporting and logging sickness, Statutory Sick Pay, fit notes and absence monitoring.

In this chapter: [Logging sickness \(manager\)](#) · [Changing a sickness end date](#) · [Statutory Sick Pay \(SSP\)](#) · [Fit notes](#) · [Bradford Factor](#) · [Absence trends](#)

Logging sickness (manager)

All plans

The 7:10am phone call: a manager records sickness for someone in a few taps and immediately sees which shifts are short and who could cover.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Only sickness types; recorded as approved straight away; no evidence needed.
- The confirmation shows the cover impact, grouped by person for long absences.
- The audit log records the manager as the actor and who it was for.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/app/(dashboard)/requests/log-sickness/page.tsx</code>	Log sickness page
<code>src/components/leave/log-sickness-form.tsx</code>	Form + cover result
<code>src/lib/leave-requests/create.ts</code>	onBehalfOfUserId path

■ REFERENCES

- > [GOV.UK – Taking sick leave \(self-certification, fit notes\)](#)
- > [Acas – Absence from work](#)

RELATED: [Statutory Sick Pay \(SSP\)](#) · [Cover warnings & suggestions](#) · [Changing a sickness end date](#)

Changing a sickness end date

All plans

Off longer, or back early? Managers move the end date so it stays one absence (one Bradford spell, one SSP period).

■ HOW IT WORKS

- SSP, Bradford, hours and fit-note status are recalculated; later linked SSP absences too.
- Can't overlap another sickness record for the same person.
- Shows the new cover impact after saving.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/leave-requests/change-end-date.ts</code>	<code>changeSicknessEndDate()</code>
<code>src/components/leave/request-card.tsx</code>	Change end date control

■ REFERENCES

- > [GOV.UK – Employers: Statutory Sick Pay](#)

RELATED: [Statutory Sick Pay \(SSP\)](#) · [Bradford Factor](#) · [Fit notes](#)

Statutory Sick Pay (SSP)

Growth+

From 6 April 2026: SSP is the lower of £123.25 a week or 80% of average weekly earnings, paid from the first day, for days the person normally works, for up to 28 weeks.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Average weekly earnings: earnings in the 8 weeks before the absence ÷ weeks recorded.
- Payable days: their qualifying (working) days only — 6 days for a 3-day worker off two weeks.
- Absences within 56 days link into one period; the 28-week cap covers the whole linked chain.
- Before 6 April 2026 the old rules apply: Lower Earnings Limit and 3 waiting days.
- Reports show SSP days, daily rate, cost to date and cost of the whole absence.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

src/lib/uk-compliance.ts	<code>calculateSspEntitlement()</code> , payable days
src/lib/leave-requests/ssp-spell.ts	<code>computeSspForSpell()</code> , linked chain
src/lib/sickness-spells.ts	<code>linkedPriorChain()</code>
src/lib/smpCalculator.ts	<code>getAweForUser()</code> (shared AWE)
src/app/api/reports/uk-compliance/route.ts	SSP liability report
src/app/tools/ssp-calculator/calculator.tsx	Public SSP calculator

■ REFERENCES

- › [GOV.UK – SSP: what you'll get \(£123.25 or 80%, days normally worked\)](#)
- › [GOV.UK – Employers: Statutory Sick Pay](#)
- › [GOV.UK – Employers: SSP, what you need to pay](#)
- › [GOV.UK – Employers: SSP eligibility and form SSP1](#)
- › [legislation.gov.uk – Employment Rights Act 2025](#)
- › [GOV.UK – Rates and thresholds for employers 2026 to 2027](#)
- › [GOV.UK – Statutory Sick Pay \(SSP\)](#)
- › [GOV.UK – Employment Rights Bill factsheets](#)

Watch out: SSP days already stored on production before 4 Oct 2026 used the old weekday rule and aren't recalculated automatically.

RELATED: [The working week \(one source of truth\)](#) · [Earnings history & average weekly earnings](#) · [Changing a sickness end date](#)

Fit notes

Recording: all · alerts: Growth+

The first 7 days of sickness are self-certified. From day 8 a fit note is needed; managers record its dates (no document or diagnosis is stored).

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Status per absence: self-certified / needed from (day 8) / covered.
- Several notes can chain (renewals); gaps are spotted.
- Recorded notes set the evidence flag the overdue list and Monday email read; typed notes don't count.
- Overdue: absences past day 7 without cover, still going or ended within 90 days.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/fit-notes.ts</code>	<code>fitNoteStatus()</code> (+ tests)
<code>src/lib/leave-requests/fit-notes.ts</code>	Record/remove, sync evidence
<code>src/components/leave/fit-note-section.tsx</code>	Fit note panel on requests
<code>src/lib/fit-note-alerts.ts</code>	Overdue selection
<code>src/components/dashboard/fit-notes-due.tsx</code>	Fit notes due card
<code>src/app/api/cron/fit-note-alerts/route.ts</code>	Monday alert email

■ REFERENCES

- > [GOV.UK – Fit note guidance \(collection\)](#)
- > [GOV.UK – Taking sick leave \(self-certification, fit notes\)](#)

RELATED: **Statutory Sick Pay (SSP)**

Bradford Factor

Growth+

An absence score: $\text{spells}^2 \times \text{days}$. Many short absences score higher than one long one. Used to prompt a conversation, not as an automatic trigger.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Overlapping records count as one spell; days aren't double-counted.
- One shared calculation for stored scores and the report.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/sickness-spells.ts</code>	<code>bradfordForSickness()</code>
<code>src/lib/leave-requests/bradford.ts</code>	<code>recomputeBradfordScore()</code>
<code>src/app/api/reports/uk-compliance/route.ts</code>	Bradford report

■ REFERENCES

- > [Acas – Absence from work](#)

Watch out: The Bradford Factor is an HR convention, not a legal requirement; use it fairly and consider disability and pregnancy-related absence.

RELATED: **Absence trends**

Absence trends

Scale+

Monthly working days of sickness per person over 12 months, to spot rising patterns early.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Separate from Bradford (a single rolling number).

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/absence-trends.ts</code>	Trend calculation
<code>src/components/reports/absence-trends-section.tsx</code>	Report section

■ REFERENCES

- > [Acas – Absence from work](#)

RELATED: **Bradford Factor**

CHAPTER 5

Cover & shifts

The heart of the product: minimum staffing per location and shift, who could cover a gap, and asking staff to cover.

In this chapter: [Locations & minimum cover](#) · [Shift types & working patterns](#) · [The cover engine](#) · [Cover warnings & suggestions](#) · [Cover requests \(ask, accept, decline\)](#) · [Cover in payroll, calendar & hours](#)

Locations & minimum cover

All plans

Group people by location (a care home, a kitchen) and set the minimum number on duty — per day, or per shift once shifts are set up.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Switched on in Settings → Optional features; managed in Settings → Locations.
- Each location decides whether weekends and bank holidays need cover.
- In code and the database these are still called “regions”.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/app/(dashboard)/settings/regions/page.tsx</code>	Locations settings
<code>src/app/api/regions/route.ts</code>	Locations API
<code>src/lib/regionCover.ts</code>	Daily cover and cover checks
<code>src/lib/coverDays.ts</code>	Which days cover applies

■ REFERENCES

- > [GOV.UK – Rest breaks at work](#)

RELATED: [Shift types & working patterns](#) · [Cover warnings & suggestions](#)

Shift types & working patterns

All plans

Shift types (Day 08:00–20:00, Night 20:00–08:00) with a minimum per weekday, and each person's weekly pattern of shifts.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- A shift belongs to the day it starts (Thursday's night runs into Friday).
- Pattern changes take effect today; history stays accurate.
- People without a pattern don't count towards shifts — the dashboard warns.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/components/settings/region-shifts-dialog.tsx</code>	Shift types editor
<code>src/components/team/work-pattern-card.tsx</code>	Pattern editor
<code>src/app/api/team-members/[id]/work-pattern/route.ts</code>	Save a pattern
<code>src/lib/workPattern.ts</code>	Ending old patterns

■ REFERENCES

- > [GOV.UK – Rest breaks at work](#)

RELATED: [The cover engine](#) · [The working week \(one source of truth\)](#)

The cover engine

All plans

The single source of truth for “is this shift covered?” — available = scheduled – on leave + accepted cover — and, for short shifts, who could cover and who can't.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Candidates: not on the shift, not on leave, and 11 hours' rest either side (Working Time Regulations).
- Ruled out shows why: on leave, needs rest, or already covering a nearby shift.
- Shows contract type and hours already scheduled that week.
- Pure function, no database, heavily tested.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/shiftCover.ts</code>	<code>computeShiftCover()</code> (+ tests)
<code>src/lib/regionCover.ts</code>	Loads data, <code>checkRegionalCover()</code>
<code>src/lib/cover-grouping.ts</code>	Group short shifts by person

■ REFERENCES

- › [legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 10 \(daily rest\)](#)
- › [GOV.UK – Rest breaks at work](#)
- › [GOV.UK – Maximum weekly working hours](#)
- › [legislation.gov.uk – Working Time Regulations 1998](#)

RELATED: [Cover warnings & suggestions](#) · [Cover requests \(ask, accept, decline\)](#)

Cover warnings & suggestions

All plans

Wherever leave affects staffing — booking, approving, logging sickness, changing dates — Coverboard shows which shifts would be short and who could cover.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- One short shift: a simple list. Several: grouped by person with “Ask for all”.
- The request card's cover badge only says OK when shifts really are covered.
- Dashboard “Cover today” widget per location.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/components/leave/regional-cover-warning.tsx</code>	Warning block
<code>src/components/leave/cover-options.tsx</code>	One shift: candidates + Ask
<code>src/components/leave/cover-by-person.tsx</code>	Grouped view
<code>src/components/leave/regional-cover-panel.tsx</code>	Panel on request cards
<code>src/components/dashboard/region-cover-widget.tsx</code>	Dashboard widget
<code>src/app/api/cover-check/route.ts</code>	Cover check API

■ REFERENCES

- › [GOV.UK – Rest breaks at work](#)

RELATED: [The cover engine](#) · [Cover requests \(ask, accept, decline\)](#)

Cover requests (ask, accept, decline)

All plans

Managers ask people to cover a short shift; they accept or decline in the app. Accepting puts them on the shift and closes the gap.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Re-checked when asked and when accepted (still short, not on leave, rested).
- First to accept takes it (a database lock stops two people filling one gap); other asks close as filled.
- Either side can pull out later (manager withdraws / person drops out), with emails both ways.
- Managers see a “Cover updates” card; staff see a count in the sidebar.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/cover-offers.ts</code>	Create, respond, withdraw, drop out
<code>src/app/api/cover-offers/route.ts</code>	Ask / list (+ batch)
<code>src/app/(dashboard)/cover-requests/page.tsx</code>	Staff page
<code>src/components/cover/cover-requests-list.tsx</code>	Accept / decline / drop out
<code>src/components/dashboard/cover-updates-list.tsx</code>	Manager updates card
<code>prisma/schema.prisma</code>	CoverOffer model

■ REFERENCES

- > [legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 10 \(daily rest\)](https://legislation.gov.uk/ukreg/2018/11/10/10)
- > [GOV.UK – Rest breaks at work](https://gov.uk/guidance/minimum-rest-breaks)

RELATED: [Cover in payroll, calendar & hours](#) · [The cover engine](#)

Cover in payroll, calendar & hours

All plans

Accepted cover is extra paid work: it appears in the payroll export, on the calendar and beside weekly hours.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- One loader for all three so they agree.
- Cover hours are shown beside logged weekly hours, never added automatically.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/cover-shifts.ts</code>	<code>loadAcceptedCoverShifts()</code> , <code>shiftLengthHours()</code>
<code>src/app/api/reports/cover-shifts/route.ts</code>	Cover shifts export
<code>src/components/reports/cover-shifts-section.tsx</code>	Payroll section

■ REFERENCES

- > [GOV.UK – Calculating holiday pay for workers without fixed hours or pay](https://gov.uk/guidance/calculating-holiday-pay-for-workers-without-fixed-hours-or-pay)
- > [GOV.UK – Holiday pay: the basics](https://gov.uk/guidance/holiday-pay-the-basics)

RELATED: [Payroll export](#) · [Irregular-hours & zero-hours holiday](#) · [Team calendar](#)

CHAPTER 6

Pay, payroll & reports

Earnings history, holiday pay, the payroll export and the reports managers use to stay compliant.

In this chapter: [Earnings history & average weekly earnings](#) · [Holiday pay \(52-week average\)](#) · [Payroll export](#) · [Compliance & operations reports](#) · [Working time \(48 hours, rest\)](#)

Earnings history & average weekly earnings

Growth+

Weekly gross earnings per person (entered or CSV-imported). They feed holiday pay (52 weeks) and SSP/SMP (8 weeks).

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Zero-pay weeks are flagged: excluded from holiday pay, included (as £0) for SSP/SMP.
- Average weekly earnings = recorded weeks in the 8 weeks before the date.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

src/app/api/team-members/[id]/earnings-history/route.ts	Earnings API
src/lib/earningsHistory.ts	CSV parsing
src/components/settings/earnings-coverage-panel.tsx	Coverage of earnings data
src/lib/smpCalculator.ts	getAweForUser()

■ REFERENCES

- > [GOV.UK – Holiday pay: the basics](#)
- > [GOV.UK – Employers: SSP, what you need to pay](#)
- > [GOV.UK – Rates and thresholds for employers 2026 to 2027](#)

RELATED: [Holiday pay \(52-week average\)](#) · [Statutory Sick Pay \(SSP\)](#)

Holiday pay (52-week average)

Growth+

A day's holiday pay is the average weekly pay over the last 52 paid weeks (looking back up to 104) divided by the days they work.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Daily rate = average week ÷ working days (£390 ÷ 3 = £130). Fixed 4 Oct 2026; it divided by 5 before.
- Irregular-hours staff use an hourly rate (pay ÷ hours).
- The rate is captured on each annual leave booking for payroll.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

src/lib/holidayPay.ts	calculateHolidayPayRate()
src/lib/payroll-export.ts	Rate fields in the export

■ REFERENCES

- > [GOV.UK – Holiday pay: the basics](#)
- > [legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 16 \(holiday pay\)](#)
- > [GOV.UK – Calculating holiday pay for workers without fixed hours or pay](#)

RELATED: [Earnings history & average weekly earnings](#) · [Payroll export](#)

Payroll export

All plans

Approved leave in a pay period with holiday pay and every statutory payment for the days in that period, plus leavers' final holiday pay and a "Cover shifts worked" export, as CSV or Excel.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Statutory pay is worked out for the pay period, not today: SSP, SMP or SAP (with a column saying which), SPP, ShPP and neonatal pay, each at the weekly rate ÷ 7 for calendar days.
- The screen shows working days, calendar days, rate and pay per row, and a statutory pay total split by type.
- Leavers whose last day is in the period get their own table, Excel sheet and CSV: built up, taken and holiday to pay.
- Money on screen has thousands separators; exports keep plain numbers.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/app/api/reports/payroll/route.ts</code>	Builds the report and exports
<code>src/lib/payroll-columns.ts</code>	Columns, defined once for screen and export
<code>src/lib/export-formats.ts</code>	CSV and Excel
<code>src/app/(dashboard)/reports/page.tsx</code>	Payroll screen

■ REFERENCES

- > [GOV.UK – Holiday pay: the basics](#)
- > [legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 14 \(pay in lieu on leaving\)](#)
- > [GOV.UK – Employers: SSP, what you need to pay](#)

RELATED: [Cover in payroll, calendar & hours](#) · [Holiday pay \(52-week average\)](#) · [Leavers & holiday owed](#)

Compliance & operations reports

Scale+ (some Growth+)

One Reports page: operations, analytics, Bradford, absence trends, cover by location, right to work, working time, holiday usage, SSP liability, parental tracker, payroll and year-end.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Holiday usage counts the team's leave year and includes bookings across its start or end.
- The parental tracker shows SMP/SAP rates (even before pay starts), ShPP, neonatal pay and weeks, KIT/SPLIT days.
- "Export compliance pack" bundles the key tables; columns are defined once for screen and export.
- Monthly compliance email for Scale+ teams; weekly digest for everyone.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/app/(dashboard)/reports/page.tsx</code>	Reports page
<code>src/app/api/reports/uk-compliance/route.ts</code>	UK compliance data
<code>src/lib/uk-compliance-columns.ts</code>	Columns and the parental leave list
<code>src/app/api/cron/monthly-compliance-report/route.ts</code>	Monthly email

■ REFERENCES

- > [GOV.UK – Employers: Statutory Sick Pay](#)
- > [GOV.UK – Check a job applicant's right to work](#)
- > [Acas – Absence from work](#)
- > [Vercel – Cron jobs](#) (developer docs)

RELATED: [Statutory Sick Pay \(SSP\)](#) · [Bradford Factor](#) · [Right to work](#) · [Working time \(48 hours, rest\)](#)

Working time (48 hours, rest)

All plans (UK staff)

A working-time report: average weekly hours over 17 weeks against the 48-hour limit, weeks over 48, and rest under 11 hours between shifts, with this week and next as rostered.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Hours come from logged hours, else hours on pay records, else the working pattern and accepted cover, minus leave: an estimate, not timesheets.
- New starters are averaged since they started (or their first recorded work).
- 48-hour opt-outs are recorded on profiles; over the average without one is flagged.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

`src/lib/working-time.ts`

`summariseWorkingTime()`

`src/components/reports/working-time-section.tsx`

Report section

■ REFERENCES

- > [legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 4 \(48-hour average\)](https://legislation.gov.uk/ukreg/1998/1626/regulation/4)
- > [GOV.UK – Maximum weekly working hours](https://gov.uk/guidance/maximum-weekly-working-hours)
- > [legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 10 \(daily rest\)](https://legislation.gov.uk/ukreg/1998/1626/regulation/10)
- > [GOV.UK – Rest breaks at work](https://gov.uk/guidance/rest-breaks-at-work)

RELATED: [Compliance & operations reports](#) · [Shift types & working patterns](#)

CHAPTER 7

Compliance, privacy & security

Right to work, audit logs, data protection (UK GDPR) and the security controls protecting the app.

In this chapter: [Right to work](#) · [Audit log & activity](#) · [Subject access, retention & deletion](#) · [Cookie consent & email preferences](#) · [Security controls](#)

Right to work

Growth+

Record each right-to-work check with its date, method, document and any expiry. Expired permission and rechecks due within 60 days are flagged everywhere, including the Monday email.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Checks are kept as a history; the latest sets the person's status.
- Time-limited permission must be checked again before it ends.
- Checks are removed 2 years after someone leaves.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/components/team/right-to-work-card.tsx</code>	Profile card
<code>src/lib/right-to-work.ts</code>	Status rules
<code>src/app/api/team-members/[id]/right-to-work/route.ts</code>	Recording checks

■ REFERENCES

- › [GOV.UK – Check a job applicant's right to work](#)

RELATED: [Compliance & operations reports](#) · [Leavers & holiday owed](#)

Audit log & activity

Viewer & exports: Pro

Every important action — approvals, overrides, sickness logged, fit notes, cover requests, settings — is recorded with who, what and when.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Pro teams also log sensitive reads (who viewed a sickness note or profile).
- Actions are a fixed list so filters stay consistent.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/audit.ts</code>	<code>recordAudit()</code> , <code>AUDIT_ACTIONS</code>
<code>src/app/(dashboard)/audit/page.tsx</code>	Audit page
<code>src/components/team/activity-log.tsx</code>	Per-person activity

■ REFERENCES

- › [ICO – Employment practices and data protection](#)

RELATED: [Roles & permissions](#)

Subject access, retention & deletion

All plans

Export everything held on a person (UK GDPR Article 15), keep holiday records for 6 years, remove former staff after the legal periods, and delete a whole account with a 30-day grace period.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- SAR export is machine-readable JSON with secrets redacted.
- Former staff are removed 6 years after leaving (right-to-work checks after 2), by the nightly job.
- Account deletion offers a 6-year records download first, is scheduled 30 days out and processed nightly.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/sar-export.ts</code>	Subject access export
<code>src/lib/former-staff-retention.ts</code>	Removal after the legal periods
<code>src/lib/deletionScheduler.ts</code>	Account deletion
<code>src/app/api/cron/process-deletions/route.ts</code>	Nightly job

■ REFERENCES

- > [ICO – Right of access \(subject access requests\)](#)
- > [ICO – Storage limitation principle](#)
- > [ICO – Employment practices and data protection](#)

RELATED: [Audit log & activity](#)

Cookie consent & email preferences

All plans

Only essential cookies until a visitor accepts analytics. Digest emails have one-click unsubscribe.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- The banner reserves space so it never hides the bottom of a page.
- Unsubscribe links are signed tokens; List-Unsubscribe headers support Gmail/Outlook one-click.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/components/cookie-banner.tsx</code>	Cookie banner
<code>src/lib/consent.ts</code>	Consent helpers
<code>src/lib/email-unsubscribe.ts</code>	Signed unsubscribe tokens

■ REFERENCES

- > [ICO – Cookies and similar technologies \(PECR\)](#)
- > [RFC 8058 – One-click unsubscribe](#) (developer docs)

RELATED: [Email & product analytics](#)

Security controls

All plans

Rate limiting on sign-in and password routes, strict security headers, error tracking, and functions pinned to London.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Upstash Redis rate limits (fail closed in production if not configured).
- Content Security Policy, HSTS, no framing; Sentry host read from the DSN.
- Vercel functions run in lhr1 (London), next to the database.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/rate-limit.ts</code>	Rate limiting
<code>next.config.ts</code>	Security headers, CSP
<code>vercel.json</code>	Region and cron schedules
<code>sentry.client.config.ts</code>	Error tracking

■ REFERENCES

- > [ICO – Employment practices and data protection](#)
- > [Vercel – Function regions](#) (developer docs)
- > [Vercel – Cron jobs](#) (developer docs)
- > [Upstash – Rate limiting](#) (developer docs)
- > [Sentry – Next.js](#) (developer docs)
- > [MDN – Content Security Policy](#) (developer docs)

CHAPTER 8

Billing & integrations

Plans and payments with Stripe, plus Slack, Jira, email and analytics.

In this chapter: **Plans, billing & VAT** · Slack & Jira · Email & product analytics

Plans, billing & VAT

Five plans (Free, Starter, Growth, Scale, Pro). Stripe handles subscriptions, payment methods, trials and VAT.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Stripe webhooks keep the plan in sync (paused, cancelled, payment failed → locked).
- Stripe Tax adds VAT on top; customers can add VAT numbers.
- Feature access is checked by plan everywhere (TRIAL = full access).

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/planFeatures.ts</code>	Features per plan
<code>src/config/pricing.ts</code>	Prices and plan copy
<code>src/lib/stripe-webhook-handlers.ts</code>	Webhook handling
<code>src/app/api/webhooks/stripe/route.ts</code>	Webhook endpoint
<code>src/components/billing/tax-section.tsx</code>	VAT numbers

■ REFERENCES

- > [Stripe – Billing and subscriptions](#) (developer docs)
- > [Stripe – Tax](#) (developer docs)
- > [Stripe – Webhooks](#) (developer docs)

RELATED: [Sign-up, plans & trials](#)

Slack & Jira

All plans

Slack: new requests posted with approve/reject buttons, DMs on decisions, and a `/requestleave` command. Jira: warns when someone with open tickets books leave and helps reassign them.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Slack and web share the same create/review logic, so rules never diverge.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/slack-notifications.ts</code>	Slack messages
<code>src/app/api/slack/commands/route.ts</code>	<code>/requestleave</code>
<code>src/app/api/slack/interactions/route.ts</code>	Approve/reject buttons
<code>src/lib/jira.ts</code>	Jira integration
<code>src/components/leave/coverage-warning.tsx</code>	Jira coverage warning

■ REFERENCES

- > [Slack API – Slash commands and interactivity](#) (developer docs)
- > [Atlassian – Jira Cloud REST API](#) (developer docs)

RELATED: [Leave requests & approvals](#)

Email & product analytics

All plans

Emails go through Resend (invites, approvals, cover requests, fit-note alerts). Product analytics (PostHog) only run with consent.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Names in emails are HTML-escaped.
- PostHog is proxied through /ingest and gated on cookie consent.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/email.ts</code>	<code>sendEmail()</code>
<code>src/lib/email-templates.ts</code>	All email templates
<code>src/lib/analytics/server.ts</code>	Server analytics
<code>src/components/analytics/posthog-provider.tsx</code>	Client analytics

■ REFERENCES

- > [ICO – Cookies and similar technologies \(PECR\)](#)
- > [Resend documentation](#) (developer docs)
- > [PostHog documentation](#) (developer docs)

RELATED: [Cookie consent & email preferences](#)

CHAPTER 9

Website & growth

The public website, SEO guides and free tools, and the alerts that tell you when someone signs up.

In this chapter: **Website, pricing, guides & tools** · Signup alerts & founder outreach

Website, pricing, guides & tools

Public

The marketing site tells the 7:10am sick-call story, explains pricing, and publishes SEO guides and free calculators.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- Guides are markdown in /marketing; only files with a title and description are published (internal notes are excluded from the sitemap).
- Free tools: SSP calculator and irregular-hours holiday calculator.
- Logged-out 404s point to the homepage and guides.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/components/landing/landing-page.tsx</code>	Homepage
<code>src/app/pricing/page.tsx</code>	Pricing page
<code>src/lib/guides.ts</code>	Guides loader
<code>src/app/sitemap.ts</code>	Sitemap
<code>src/app/tools/ssp-calculator/calculator.tsx</code>	SSP calculator

■ REFERENCES

- > [GOV.UK – SSP: what you'll get \(£123.25 or 80% days normally worked\)](#)
- > [GOV.UK – Calculating holiday pay for workers without fixed hours or pay](#)

RELATED: **Signup alerts & founder outreach**

Signup alerts & founder outreach

Internal

You get an email when a team signs up and again when it finishes onboarding. The first 100 verified admins also get a personal email from you.

■ HOW IT WORKS

- SIGNUP_ALERT_TO sets recipients (default hello@coverboard.io; “off” disables; quiet on preview deploys).
- Founder outreach is capped (FOUNDER_OUTREACH_CAP) and sent once per team.

■ WHERE IN THE CODE

<code>src/lib/signup-alerts.ts</code>	Signup alerts
<code>src/lib/founder-outreach.ts</code>	Founder email

■ REFERENCES

- > [Resend documentation](#) (developer docs)

RELATED: **Sign-up, plans & trials**

CHAPTER 10

Known limitations

What the app doesn't do yet, or does with an assumption you should know about. Keep this list honest — it's what protects you when you make compliance claims.

Calculations corrected 4–7 Oct 2026

Holiday pay, SSP, SMP and other family pay, starter proration, carry-over and the 26-week service test were corrected after tester feedback. Run `npm run recalculate:ssp` after deploying to refresh stored SSP and SMP.

Shared parental pay pool

The app only sees this employee's claims and their own maternity or adoption pay; the other parent's share comes off the same pool.

Overseas adoption and surrogacy

Their pay dates differ (arrival in the UK, or 15 weeks before the due date) and should be worked out by hand.

Unpaid parental leave year

Uses the default scheme's per-child year; a collective or workforce agreement that sets another year isn't supported.

Working days without a pattern

Without a working pattern only the number of days is known, so Monday–Friday is assumed when counting which days were missed.

Average earnings with gaps

Weeks with no earnings record are treated as missing, not £0, and the card says so. Record zero-pay weeks explicitly so averages are right.

Cover needs fixed weekly patterns

Shift cover assumes the same pattern each week. Teams whose rota changes weekly will see inaccurate cover until a rota feature exists.

Holiday on leaving

Covers the allowance the app knows; contract terms such as rounding up to half days are for the employer.

Not legal advice

Coverboard implements published GOV.UK and legislation.gov.uk rules, but figures should be checked by your payroll provider before payment.

CHAPTER 11

Reference index

Every source cited in this guide, with the features that rely on it. All links were checked when the guide was generated.

Legislation

legislation.gov.uk – Employment Rights Act 2025	Statutory Sick Pay (SSP)
legislation.gov.uk – Maternity and Parental Leave etc. Regs 1999, Sch. 2 (the 4-week year per child)	Bereavement, unpaid parental & carer's leave
legislation.gov.uk – SPP and SAP (General) Regs 2002, reg. 40 (adoption earnings period)	Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP
legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 10 (daily rest)	The cover engine, Cover requests (ask, accept, decline), Working time (48 hours, rest)
legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 13 (annual leave)	Leave balances & entitlement, Leave year, Carry-over & year-end rollover
legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 14 (pay in lieu on leaving)	Leavers & holiday owed, Payroll export
legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 16 (holiday pay)	Holiday pay (52-week average)
legislation.gov.uk – WTR reg. 4 (48-hour average)	Working time (48 hours, rest)
legislation.gov.uk – Working Time Regulations 1998	Leave balances & entitlement, The cover engine

GOV.UK guidance

GOV.UK – Adoption pay and leave	—
GOV.UK – Calculate leave entitlement (part-time, part-year)	Team members & profiles, Leave balances & entitlement, The working week (one source of truth), Irregular-hours & zero-hours holiday
GOV.UK – Calculate your holiday entitlement (calculator)	Leave balances & entitlement
GOV.UK – Calculating holiday pay for workers without fixed hours or pay	Irregular-hours & zero-hours holiday, Cover in payroll, calendar & hours, Holiday pay (52-week average), Website, pricing, guides & tools
GOV.UK – Carer's leave	Statutory leave types (in weeks), Bereavement, unpaid parental & carer's leave
GOV.UK – Check a job applicant's right to work	Compliance & operations reports, Right to work
GOV.UK – Employers: SSP eligibility and form SSP1	Statutory Sick Pay (SSP)
GOV.UK – Employers: SSP, what you need to pay	Statutory Sick Pay (SSP), Earnings history & average weekly earnings, Payroll export
GOV.UK – Employers: Statutory Sick Pay	Changing a sickness end date, Statutory Sick Pay (SSP), Compliance & operations reports
GOV.UK – Employers: adoption pay and leave	Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP
GOV.UK – Employers: adoption pay eligibility (matching week)	Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP
GOV.UK – Employers: maternity leave (incl. KIT days)	KIT & SPLIT days
GOV.UK – Employers: maternity pay and leave	Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP

GOV.UK – Employers: neonatal care pay and leave	Neonatal care leave & pay
GOV.UK – Employers: neonatal care pay eligibility (relevant week)	Neonatal care leave & pay
GOV.UK – Employers: paternity pay and leave	Paternity leave & SPP
GOV.UK – Employment Rights Bill factsheets	Statutory Sick Pay (SSP)
GOV.UK – Fit note guidance (collection)	Fit notes
GOV.UK – Holiday entitlement	Onboarding, Leave requests & approvals, Carry-over & year-end rollover
GOV.UK – Holiday entitlement: entitlement (5.6 weeks)	Leave balances & entitlement, Leave year, Bank holidays
GOV.UK – Holiday pay: the basics	Cover in payroll, calendar & hours, Earnings history & average weekly earnings, Holiday pay (52-week average), Payroll export
GOV.UK – Maternity benefits: technical guidance (26 weeks into the qualifying week)	Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP
GOV.UK – Maternity leave (52 weeks)	Statutory leave types (in weeks)
GOV.UK – Maternity pay and leave	—
GOV.UK – Maximum weekly working hours	The cover engine, Working time (48 hours, rest)
GOV.UK – Neonatal care pay and leave	Neonatal care leave & pay
GOV.UK – Parental Bereavement Pay and Leave	Statutory leave types (in weeks), Bereavement, unpaid parental & carer's leave
GOV.UK – Paternity pay and leave	Statutory leave types (in weeks), Paternity leave & SPP
GOV.UK – Rates and thresholds for employers 2026 to 2027	Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP, Statutory Sick Pay (SSP), Earnings history & average weekly earnings
GOV.UK – Rest breaks at work	Locations & minimum cover, Shift types & working patterns, The cover engine, Cover warnings & suggestions, Cover requests (ask, accept, decline), Working time (48 hours, rest)
GOV.UK – SSP: what you'll get (£123.25 or 80%, days normally worked)	The working week (one source of truth), Statutory Sick Pay (SSP), Website, pricing, guides & tools
GOV.UK – Shared Parental Leave and Pay	Shared parental leave & ShPP
GOV.UK – Shared Parental Leave and Pay: employer guide	Shared parental leave & ShPP
GOV.UK – Shared Parental Leave: employer guidance (SPLIT days)	KIT & SPLIT days
GOV.UK – Shared parental leave and pay: employers' technical guide	Shared parental leave & ShPP
GOV.UK – Statutory Sick Pay (SSP)	Statutory Sick Pay (SSP)
GOV.UK – Taking holiday before leaving a job	Leavers & holiday owed
GOV.UK – Taking sick leave (self-certification, fit notes)	Logging sickness (manager), Fit notes
GOV.UK – UK bank holidays	Onboarding, Bank holidays, Team calendar
GOV.UK – Unpaid parental leave	Statutory leave types (in weeks), Bereavement, unpaid parental & carer's leave
HMRC manual – Continuous employment (statutory payments)	Maternity & adoption: SMP and SAP

Acas

Acas – Absence from work	Logging sickness (manager), Bradford Factor, Absence trends, Compliance & operations reports
Acas – Checking holiday entitlement	Leave requests & approvals
Acas – Holiday and sickness	Leave requests & approvals, Carry-over & year-end rollover

Information Commissioner's Office (UK GDPR)

ICO – Cookies and similar technologies (PECR)	Cookie consent & email preferences, Email & product analytics
ICO – Employment practices and data protection	Inviting people (set-password links), Roles & permissions , Audit log & activity , Subject access, retention & deletion , Security controls
ICO – Right of access (subject access requests)	Subject access, retention & deletion
ICO – Storage limitation principle	Subject access, retention & deletion

Developer documentation

Next.js documentation	Architecture
Prisma documentation	Architecture
NextAuth.js documentation	Roles & permissions
Stripe – Billing and subscriptions	Sign-up, plans & trials , Plans, billing & VAT
Stripe – Tax	Plans, billing & VAT
Stripe – Webhooks	Plans, billing & VAT
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PostHog documentation	Email & product analytics
Slack API – Slash commands and interactivity	Slack & Jira
Atlassian – Jira Cloud REST API	Slack & Jira
MDN – Content Security Policy	Security controls
RFC 8058 – One-click unsubscribe	Cookie consent & email preferences